

# TANISHA KOTHARI

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

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Full-stack software developer and Computer Science student at the University of Sydney, specialising in end-to-end web and systems development across React, Node.js and Python. Proven track record shipping production systems, winning competitive hackathons, and delivering real business impact as a solo developer. Seeking software engineering internships to contribute to production systems and deepen expertise in systems design and large-scale architecture.

## EDUCATION

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### Bachelor of Advanced Computing

Jul 2024 – Jul 2028

The University of Sydney

WAM: 82.56 | Relevant Coursework: Data Structures & Algorithms, Artificial Intelligence, OOP, OS & Network Platforms, Distributed Systems, Systems Programming, Data & Information Management

## EXPERIENCE

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### Full-Stack Developer – Yogi Foods

Jan 2026 – Present

- Building a production-grade B2B/B2C e-commerce platform from scratch (React, Node.js/Express, MySQL, sub-2s page load), replacing a no-code website builder to give the business full control over features, integrations, and UI.
- Integrated Stripe for card payments, custom invoice generation (swissqrbill), and OAuth 2.0 social login, handling end-to-end authentication and payment flows.
- Deployed via Docker on AWS Lightsail with Nginx reverse proxy and rate limiting for production routing, security, and performance.
- Implemented MySQL master-slave replication and automated backups using Docker on AWS, improving database resilience and disaster recovery readiness.

### Chess Coach – Sydney Academy of Chess

Aug 2025 – Present

- Coaching primary school students; 30+ taught to date by communicating complex concepts simply and adapting teaching methods to different learning styles.

### FutureFocus Program (Tech Stream) – Optiver

May 2026

- Designed and built a functional exchange simulator in 3 days with a partner using Python: order book and matching engine, risk management, and multi-client order routing.
- Prioritised system architecture design before implementation; navigated complex concurrency and race condition challenges inherent to a live, multi-client trading environment.

### Software Developer – e12.io

Mar 2025 – Jan 2026

- Built the first functional user-facing interface for a production IoT platform: full-stack, JWT/OAuth 2.0, MySQL, multi-user access control.
- Engineered Node.js REST APIs serving as the sole live data layer between IoT devices and the application.
- Delivered Svelte dashboards enabling real-time data visualisation and user onboarding on a live system.

## INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

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### EcoTrace – AI-powered environmental impact analyser

Aug 2025

Python · FastAPI · Ollama · SQLite

- Won Most Innovative AI App at HackNode Australia 2025 – designed and built end-to-end as a solo developer.
- AI-powered EcoScore engine using a locally hosted LLM (Ollama), barcode scanning (OpenCV, pyzbar), web scraping (BeautifulSoup4), and REST APIs for product lookup and history tracking.
- React + Next.js frontend with Chart.js data visualisations and mobile-first design.

## Australian Chess Championships 2026 Website

May 2025 – Jan 2026

WordPress · [australianchampionships.usydchessclub.org](https://australianchampionships.usydchessclub.org)

- Built the sole online presence for a national tournament: production-ready site that served 31k+ requests from 2k+ users weekly across Australia and overseas.

## PortalPaths – Maze Multiverse – 2D procedural maze game

Dec 2024 – Mar 2025

C++ · Raylib · [tanishakothari.itch.io/portalpaths](https://tanishakothari.itch.io/portalpaths)

- Publicly released on itch.io for Linux: procedural maze generation, dynamic difficulty scaling, multiple themes, powerups, timed/untimed modes, and leaderboard tracking, built solo in C++.

## COMPETITIONS & AWARDS

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### Citadel Terminal APAC 2026

Apr 2026

- Developed a Python strategy for a global AI programming competition, competing head-to-head in a tower defence-style elimination tournament.
- Designed path manipulation tactics around adaptability: funnelling opponents into concentrated defences, alternating attack sides, and simulating paths to select the least-damage entry point.

### HSIL Hackathon 2026 – Solely (AI Diabetes Screening Tool)

Apr 2026

- Proposed an AI foot-imaging tool to detect diabetes risk in underserved, non-white populations (up to 4x higher risk) – Placed 4th/17.
- Adapted direction three times under mentor guidance, collaborating across a multi-disciplinary team; final pivot came from recognising a teammate's domain experience and building around that rather than forcing a domain none of us understood.

### HackNode Australia 2025 – EcoTrace (AI-driven Sustainability Web App)

Aug 2025

- Built and delivered a full-stack AI platform independently – won Most Innovative AI App.

## SKILLS

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Programming Languages – Python, JavaScript, C++, Java, C, SQL

Frameworks & Tools – Node.js, Flask, React, Svelte, HTML/CSS, TailwindCSS, Git, Docker, AWS, Nginx

Concepts – Data Structures & Algorithms, Software Design, OOP, Linux, TCP/IP, Database Design

Soft Skills – Problem solving, Collaboration, Critical thinking, Analytical skill, Adaptability, Leadership

## LEADERSHIP & VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

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### General Executive – USYD Chess Club

May 2025 – Present

- Update and maintain club website, showcasing events and weekly meetups.
- Organise events and tournaments and support weekly operations for a club of 500+ members.

### ENGO Peer Mentor – The University of Sydney

Feb 2025 – Nov 2025

- Mentored first-year engineering students through the academic and social transition to university, providing support across coursework and campus life to help them settle in smoothly.